THREE DAYS OF GREEN TESTS AND A DEAD BUTTON

Every test in the platform passed. The one button a rep needed most did nothing.

WHAT I BELIEVED ON DAY THREE

green
THE WHOLE SUITE

3 days
OF BELIEVING IT

1
BUTTON THAT WAS DEAD

0
TESTS THAT TOUCHED IT

The suite was not lying. It had never been asked the question.

A TEST PROVES THE THING IT TOUCHES

The tests covered the functions underneath. The failure was in the wiring between the page and those functions, which no test had an opinion about.

So every check I ran agreed with me, and all of them were answering a different question than the one I thought I was asking.

FOUR CHECKS THAT AGREE WITH YOU FOR FREE

01	A test suite that never loads the page a person uses	SILENT
02	A deploy that reports success for shipping the old build	SILENT
03	A login wall answering before your code does	SILENT
04	A log with no errors in it because nothing ran	SILENT

The build proves it, not the test suite. Open the page a human opens, and press the thing a human presses.

EVERY CLAIM OF LIVE NOW NEEDS ONE SCREENSHOT OF THE WORKING SURFACE, TAKEN AFTER THE DEPLOY.

I said a feature was live once when it was not. That is where this rule came from.

HOW I CLOSE A BUILD NOW

BEFORE

Suite green

Tests pass, deploy reports success, mark it done, tell somebody it shipped.

NOW

Hands on it

Load the real page, press the real control, watch the real record change. Then mark it done.

It costs about ninety seconds and it has caught four of these.

THE SAME TRAP, WITHOUT CODE

Your process document says the confirmation goes out. Your inbox says the mail merge ran. Neither of those is a client holding a confirmation.

Pick the one thing you are most sure works because a report says so. Then go be the customer for five minutes.

BUILT BY SOMEBODY WHO USES IT

I sell promotional products for a living, so every one of these gets found the hard way, on a working day.

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